Lara Karki lschenck3@gatech.edu | (724) 244-2491 | larakarki.com | linkedin.com/in/notlaura | Atlanta, GA

EDUCATION

Georgia Institute of Technology, Ph.D. Candidate, Human-Centered Computing Aug 2022 - est. May 2027

- *Dissertation:* "Broadening Pathways in Computing"
- *Advisor:* Besty DiSalvo
- *Committee:* Tawanna Dillahunt, Becki Grinter, Judith Uchidiuno, Bhumika Chauhan

School of the Museum of Fine Arts at Tufts University, Bachelor of Fine Arts, Boston, MA Aug 2009 – May 2011

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Georgia Institute of Technology, Graduate Research Assistant, Culture and Technology Lab Aug 2022 – Present

PUBLICATIONS

Full Papers

Lara Karki, Hannah Grosswieser, Eureka Wagner-Kobayashi, Ian P. Swift, Michael Muller, Dana Priest, Robert Wolfe, and Betsy DiSalvo. "The Post-Builder Perspective: Recognizing the Computing Work & Labor of Everyday People." *Under review for CHI 2027.*

Lara Karki, Kayla Uleah, Carl DiSalvo, Sierra Traynail Ross, Jadin Butler, Selamawit Husein, Emanuel Bryant, Dana Priest, Justin Booker, and Betsy DiSalvo. 2025. "'I get hives when I come on here': Persisting Through Platform-Delivered Microaggressions on LinkedIn." Proc. ACM Hum.-Comput. Interact. 9, 7, Article CSCW232 (November 2025), 36 pages. https://doi.org/10.1145/3757413

Lara Karki, Dana Priest, et al. 2025. "A Window into DataWorks: Developing an Integrated Work-Training Curriculum for Novice Adults". In Proceedings of the 56th ACM Technical Symposium on Computer Science Education V. 1 (SIGCSETS 2025). Association for Computing Machinery, New York, NY, USA, 568–574. https://doi.org/10.1145/3641554.3701826

Carl DiSalvo, Annabel Rothschild, **Lara L. Schenck**, Ben Rydal Shapiro, and Betsy DiSalvo. 2024. When Workers Want to Say No: A View into Critical Consciousness and Workplace Democracy in Data Work. Proc. ACM Hum.-Comput. Interact. 8, CSCW1, Article 156 (April 2024), 24 pages. https://doi.org/10.1145/3637433

Short Papers

Lara Karki, Aarti Israni, Kayla Uleah, Tawanna Dillahunt, Julie Hui, and Betsy DiSalvo. "Beyond the User vs. Builder Binary: Reframing Computing Work and Occupations." *Accepted Case Study for GROUP 2027.*

Lara Karki, Aarti Israni, Tawanna Dillahunt, Julie Hui, Dana Priest, Asher Brown, and Betsy DiSalvo. 2026. Recognizing, Supporting, and Futuring Diverse Pathways in Computing Work. In Adjunct Proceedings of the 5th Annual Symposium on Human-Computer Interaction for Work (CHIWORK Adjunct '26). Association for Computing Machinery, New York, NY, USA, Article 33, 1–4. https://doi.org/10.1145/3805029.3818267

Lara L. Schenck and Betsy DiSalvo. 2023. From Data Work to Data Science: Getting Past the Gatekeepers. In Proceedings of the 2023 ACM Conference on International Computing Education Research - Volume 2 (ICER '23), Vol. 2. Association for Computing Machinery, New York, NY, USA, 1–2. https://doi.org/10.1145/3568812.3603468

Manuscripts in Preparation

"Epistemologies of Programming" with Idel Martinez-Ramos, Sabine Verdult, Dana Priest, Asher Brown, Felienne Hermans, and Betsy DiSalvo.

"Research through Career Development" with Asher Brown, Dana Priest, Joshua Fortier, Briana Evans-Lopez, Oschaya Ellis, Justin Booker, and Betsy DiSalvo.

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Georgia Institute of Technology, *Instructor of Record* — Atlanta, GA

- Cognitive Science & LLMs (CS 8001; 73 Students) — May 2026 – Aug 2026
- Research Seminar (CS 8903)
  - AI & Hiring (10 students across 3+ terms) — Aug 2025 – Present
  - Software Engineering Labor Conditions (1 student) — Aug 2026 – Present
  - DataWorks Business Development (2 students) — Aug 2026 – Present

Georgia Institute of Technology, *Graduate Teaching Assistant* — Atlanta, GA

- Creative Design Practice (CS 8803); Instructor: Carl DiSalvo — Jan 2026 – May 2026
  - Guest Lecture: *LLMs and Creative Practice*
- Intro to Ph.D. Studies (CS 8803); Instructor: Betsy DiSalvo — Aug 2025 – Dec 2025
  - Guest Lecture: *Academic Websites*

Additional Teaching — National

- Atlanta Mission, *Next Steps Volunteer Facilitator* – Atlanta, GA — 2026 – Present
- DataWorks @ Georgia Tech, *Career Development Founder & Facilitator* – Atlanta, GA — 2022 – 2025
- Westinghouse High School, *TEALS Computer Science Classroom Support Volunteer* – Pittsburgh, PA — 2021
- University of Southern California, *Adjunct Instructor; WordPress Development* – Los Angeles, CA — 2018
- Pratt Institute of Design, *Adjunct Instructor*; *UI/UX Prototyping in Code, Coding I-II* – New York, NY — 2015 – 2016
- Decoded, *Executive Education Facilitator; Code in a Day* – New York, NY — 2014 – 2016
- General Assembly, *Lead Instructor; Front-End Web Development* – New York, NY — 2013 – 2014
- Saxifrage School, *Co-Instructor;* Front-end Web Development – Pittsburgh, PA — 2012

PRESENTATIONS

Invited Talks

Are LLMs making me dumber?, Allegheny County Department of Human Services, Pittsburgh — 2026
Cognition and LLMs, Responsible AI Group, Merck, Rahway — 2025
Platform Delivered Microaggressions on LinkedIn**,** STS Symposium at Georgia Tech — 2023
CSS Algorithms, Minsk, Belarus — 2020
Algorithms in CSS, CSS Day, Amsterdam, Netherlands — 2019
Understanding Today's CSS with Algorithms, SIGNAL (Twilio), San Francisco, CA — 2018

Conference Presentations

Recognizing, Supporting, and Futuring Diverse Pathways in Computing, CHIWORK 2026, Linz, Austria — 2026
Platform Delivered Microaggressions on LinkedIn, CSCW 2025, Bergen, Norway — 2025
A Window into DataWorks, SIGCSE TS 2025, Pittsburgh, PA — 2025
Re-thinking Skill in Times of Technological Change, Critical Computing Group, Atlanta, GA — 2024
Novice-Friendly Computational Work, ICER 2023, Chicago, IL — 2023
CSS Algorithms, Strange Loop, St. Louis, MO — 2019
Is CSS a Programming Language? Abstractions II, Pittsburgh, PA — 2019
CSS Algorithms, JSConf US, San Diego, CA — 2019
Writing CSS Algorithms, CSS Camp, Barcelona, Spain — 2019
CSS Is a Programming Language, WordCamp Montclair, Montclair, NJ — 2019
Bridging the Gap Between Design & Development with CSS Algorithms, WordCamp US, Nashville, TN — 2018
The Algorithms of CSS, js.la, Los Angeles, CA — 2018
The Algorithms of CSS, CSSConf EU, Berlin, Germany — 2018

Gutenberg Q&A Panel (panelist) and co-organizer, WordCamp Los Angeles, Los Angeles, CA 2018
Let's Build a Gutenberg Block, WordCamp Europe, Belgrade, Serbia 2018
Let's Build a Gutenberg Block, WordCamp San Diego, San Diego, CA 2018
The Five-Figure WordPress Website, Abstractions, Pittsburgh, PA 2016
Vetting and Choosing Themes, WordCamp Pittsburgh, Pittsburgh, PA 2016
Why the Designer Failed FizzBuzz, SassConf, Austin, TX 2015
Sassy WordPress, WordCamp Montreal, Montreal, Canada 2014
Freelancing, Real Talk, WordCamp NYC, New York, NY 2014

Podcast Appearances

Lara Schenck on CSS Algorithms and Turd-Driven Development, React Podcast with Michael Chen 2019
The Value of HTML and CSS with Mandy Michael and Lara Schenck, ShopTalk Show 2017
WordPress Development, Freelancing, and Taking Time Off, The Versioning Show (SitePoint) 2017
Road to Sass Conf, Sass Bites Podcast 2015
Guest, Episode 171, ShopTalk Show 2015

Doctoral Consortia and Workshop Participation

ACM Future Leaders of AI Doctoral Consortium, Atlanta 2026
Critical Futures of Work Workshop, CSCW 2025, Bergen 2025
CRA Women in Computing, San Francisco 2023

INDUSTRY EXPERIENCE

Merck, *Commercial AI Capabilities Intern*, Rahway, NJ June 2025 – Aug 2025

- Developed a 4-pillar human-centered AI roadmap for Merck commercial leadership through a 25-stakeholder diagnostic spanning Human Health, Animal Health, and R&D; identified critical adoption bottlenecks and force-ranked priorities across adoption, empowerment, human-AI collaboration, and governance.
- Translated academic research into actionable strategy through presentations to AI Leadership, Responsible AI group (100+ members), and Human Health division; designed protocols identifying user segments and barriers in Gen AI product adoption.

Penske Media Corporation, *Principal Software Engineer*, Los Angeles, CA June 2018 – May 2022

- Identified gap design and engineering processes causing slow platform migrations and poor cross-functional communication; built business case and secured executive buy-in, then led full-scale implementation, increasing re-platforming capacity by 60%.
- Led change management through documentation, training, and communication channels, facilitating alignment across an 80-person product and engineering organization.

Lara Schenck LLC, *Founder & Technical Consultant***,** Pittsburgh, PA and New York, NY Aug 2011 – June 2018

- Managed and executed end-to-end client engagements across branding, design, development, strategy, and technical training for 30+ clients including The Weather Channel and Barnes & Noble, small businesses, and startups.
- Established thought leadership through speaking at 19+ international industry conferences (audiences of 500+ and 40k+ recording views), developing and teaching online courses, and publishing tutorials and online.

FELLOWSHIPS & AWARDS

Foley Scholar Finalist, Institute for People and Technology, Georgia Institute of Technology 2026
Graduate Research Fellowship ($159,000), National Science Foundation 2023-2027
Pathbreakers Fellowship ($34,000), Georgia Institute of Technology 2024
President's Fellowship, Georgia Institute of Technology 2022

RESEARCH MENTORING

Elizabeth Jamison, M.S. Computer Science, Georgia Tech	2026 – Present
Austin Fulbright, M.S. Computer Science, Georgia Tech	2026 – Present
Grace Gong, M.S. Computer Science, Georgia Tech	2026 – Present
Justin W. Thomas, M.S. Computer Science, Georgia Tech	2026 – Present
Alicia N. Bochnak, M.S. Computer Science, Georgia Tech	2025 – Present
Marine Regnault, M.S. Computer Science, Georgia Tech	2025 – Present
James T. Roberts, M.S. Computer Science, Georgia Tech	2025 – Present
Yashika Reddy, B.S. Computer Science, Georgia Tech	2025 – Present
Asher Brown, Data Fellow, DataWorks, Georgia Tech	2024 – Present
Dana Priest, Training Coordinator, DataWorks, Georgia Tech	2022 – Present
Saurabh Kalia, M.S. Computer Science, Georgia Tech	2025 – 2026
Kunyeul Lee, M.S. Computer Science, Georgia Tech	2026
Minhaz Jisan, M.S. Computer Science, Georgia Tech	2026
Eric Oliphant, M.S. Computer Science, Georgia Tech	2026
Ding (Dean) Ding Tian, M.S. Computer Science, Georgia Tech	2025
Alésandra Baca-Vazques, Ph.D. Human-Centered Computing, Georgia Tech	2025

SERVICE

Academic Service

Lead Organizer, Workshop at CHIWORK 2026, Linz	2026
Co-Organizer, ATL Pre-CHI Event, Atlanta SIGCHI Chapter, Atlanta	2026

Reviewer GROUP (2026), TOCE (2023, 2025, 2026), CHI (2025, 2027), CSCW (2025), SIGCSE (2024, 2025), DIS (2023)

University Service

Founder & Lead Organizer, HCC Writing Group, Georgia Institute of Technology	2023 – Present
Co-Founder & Mentor, "IC Buddies" Ph.D. Mentor Program, Georgia Institute of Technology	2025 – Present
Participant, GVU Showcase, Institute for People and Technology, Georgia Institute of Technology	2023 – 2025

Industry Service

Open Source Contributor, WordPress Core	2014 – 2022
Founder & Lead Organizer, CSS.la Meetup, Los Angeles	2018 – 2019
Volunteer, WordCamp LA Conference, Los Angeles	2018
HelpDesk Volunteer, WordCamp NYC, Nashville	2018
Founder & Lead Organizer, CodePen NYC Meetup, New York	2014 – 2016
Regular Presenter, WordPress NYC Meetup, New York	2013 – 2016